

CYBERSECURITY INCIDENT INVESTIGATION REPORT

Ransomware Incident Reconstruction

*FokkeBV – Brainz 4 Life
Professional Portfolio Case Study*

By W4lk3r

1. Executive Summary

This investigation reconstructs a ransomware incident using documented file, process, DNS, authentication, and employee telemetry. The evidence describes suspicious authentication, reconnaissance of domain controllers, lateral movement using PsExec, creation of a persistence account, delivery of a malicious batch script to a compromised domain controller, and subsequent encryption-related impact.

2. Key Findings

Ransomware Indicators

Indicator	Observed Value
Ransom note	z0mbiz_ate_uR_f!lez.txt
SHA-256	4e10421ccbd37461dd51c59e719e401ca3bcb6291cabdccccbe3343cd5e43755
First creation	2025-10-27T09:17:44.000Z
Encryption extension	.Z0mbyt3
Last documented recurring command	2025-10-28T10:59:26.000Z

Domain Controller Compromise

The batch script z0mbytes.bat was documented on compromised domain controller DC_offices at 2025-10-26T09:12:49.000Z under username IT_god_mode. Process telemetry documented curl downloading the script from traintofokke.boo/n0mnom/z0mbytes.bat. The user cordyceps was documented as persistence on the domain controller, and gpupdate /force was recorded as the final command used to push the batch file.

Attacker Infrastructure

Infrastructure	Observed Value
Download domain	traintofokke.boo
Associated IP	206.188.196.20
Additional domain	allyourportarebelongto.us
Additional domain	yummybrains.food

Authentication and Lateral Movement

A successful login was documented at 2025-10-25T07:56:03.000Z on EWSI-LAPTOP from 162.33.177.56 for username anbonny. Employee correlation identified the full name as Anne Bonny. DC_warehouses was identified as another hostname in the documented login sequence. The investigation identified psexec.exe as the Windows Sysinternals utility used for movement between machines.

Domain Reconnaissance

The documented reconnaissance command was: `Get-ADDomainController -filter * | Select-Object -Property Name, Domain, IPv4Address, OperatingSystem | Export-Csv -Path C:\Windows\Temp\DClist.csv -NoTypeInfoInformation`

3. Reconstructed Timeline

Timestamp / Sequence	Event
2025-10-25T07:56:03.000Z	Successful suspicious login involving anbonny.
Reconnaissance phase	Domain controllers enumerated and exported to DClist.csv.
Lateral movement	psexec.exe documented.
2025-10-26T09:12:49.000Z	z0mbytes.bat documented on DC_offices.
2025-10-27T09:17:44.000Z	First ransom-note creation.
2025-10-28T10:59:26.000Z	Last documented recurring malicious command activity.

4. Attack Chain Assessment

Stage	Assessment
Access	Successful authentication from suspicious infrastructure.
Reconnaissance	Domain controllers and environment information enumerated.
Lateral Movement	PSEXEC documented.
Persistence	cordyceps account created.
Payload Delivery	z0mbytes.bat downloaded from attacker infrastructure.
Execution / Propagation	Activity on compromised domain controller followed by policy update.
Impact	Ransom note and .Z0mbyt3 extension observed.

5. Key Indicators of Compromise

- z0mbiz_ate_uR_f!lez.txt
- 4e10421ccbd37461dd51c59e719e401ca3bcb6291cabdccccbe3343cd5e43755
- .Z0mbyt3
- z0mbytes.bat
- 27d90611f005db3a25a4211cf8f69fb46097c6c374905d7207b30e87d296e1b3
- traintofokke.bo0
- 206.188.196.20
- allyourportarebelongto.us
- yummybrains.food

- cordyceps
- 162.33.177.56
- EWSI-LAPTOP
- DC_offices
- DC_warehouses

6. Conclusion

The documented evidence supports a coordinated ransomware intrusion progressing from suspicious authentication to reconnaissance, lateral movement, persistence, payload delivery, and encryption-related impact. Compromise of a domain controller represented a critical escalation point and increased the potential scope of the incident.

7. Recommended Response Actions

- Isolate affected systems and preserve forensic evidence.
- Treat domain controllers and privileged identities as potentially compromised.
- Disable and investigate unauthorized persistence accounts.
- Block and hunt for documented domains, IPs, hashes, filenames, and extensions.
- Review successful authentications from suspicious infrastructure.
- Investigate PsExec and domain-controller enumeration activity enterprise-wide.
- Reset exposed privileged credentials and validate Active Directory integrity.
- Validate backups before restoration.